

AN EAR TO THE GROUND

ED DANFORTH

Southern Bosses Optimistic for 1956; Two New Managers; Better Gates Seen

Southern Leaguers did their Christmas manager shopping early . . . that is, early last summer . . . and the association starts the 1956 campaign with only two new ones. This time last season seven new boys were hopefully listening for the starter's gun.

The 1955 operations were rugged. Cal Ermer at Chattanooga was the only holdover pilot in the lodge. Of the seven new captains who started two were booted out in mid-season and one had to have help after he was conked by a pitched ball.



Danforth

As they oil their tack for a new race, Ermer is still at Chattanooga and in good standing.

Clyde King, who was pulled in to replace George McQuinn by the Crackers in July, has been given the nod to start from scratch.

Steve Souchock, who replaced Bob Mavis at Little Rock in midstream, has been paged to take charge from the start and see how far he can go.

Jack Cassini had the Memphis Chicks going fine, but he was badly injured by a pitched ball and had to have assistance. The Chicks went on

to win the pennant and Jack is ready to go again good as ever.

Phil Page did a fine job at Birmingham to win the all-Star game site and is on the job again.

When Mobile switched from working with the Dodgers to an agreement with the Cleveland Indians it erased Clay Bryant and brought in Jo Jo White for the Bears.

Ernie White, who won a pennant with Columbia, S.C., a farm of the Reds, has been moved up to the Nashville Vols where Bill McCarthy is doing such a fine rebuilding job.

Andy Cohen is back for his second year at New Orleans with the front office reorganized under ownership of local financiers and a working agreement maintained with the Pirates.

From Charlie Hurth's office comes an optimistic prediction that the league has started back and will check the skid in attendance that has hit all minor leagues in the past few years. He says better times are in the air and who is to argue about it?